Electric Iron



Category: **Sewing, Textile & Handicraft** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 9 labs

Covers these lab items: Iron; Iron and Iron Board; Iron and Ironing Board; Iron box; Press/iron (any type) with table; Steam iron

What it is used for

An electric iron uses heat, and sometimes steam, to remove wrinkles from suitable fabrics. Correct temperature selection, safe handling, and proper storage help prevent burns, electric shock, and fabric damage.

Main parts

- Soleplate transfers heat to the fabric.
- Heating element produces the required heat.
- Handle provides a safe grip during ironing.
- Temperature control selects the setting for different fabrics.
- Power cord and plug supply electrical power.
- Water reservoir stores water in steam iron models.
- Steam control and spray outlets release moisture on supported models.

Before you start

1. Read the manufacturer's instructions and check that the iron suits the fabric.
2. Inspect the soleplate, handle, cord, plug, and controls for damage.
3. Place the ironing board on a stable, level surface away from walkways.
4. Check the fabric care label and select the recommended temperature.
5. Fill a steam iron only as instructed, with the iron unplugged and cool.
6. Keep water away from the plug, socket, and other electrical connections.

How to use

1. Set up the ironing board securely and arrange the fabric flat on it.
2. Select the temperature according to the fabric care label.
3. Plug the iron into a suitable electrical outlet with dry hands.
4. Switch on the iron and wait until it reaches the selected temperature.
5. Place the fabric flat and move the iron steadily across it.
6. Use steam or spray only if the fabric and iron instructions allow it.
7. Keep the hot soleplate moving and avoid leaving it on one spot.
8. Stand the iron upright or use its designated rest when pausing.
9. Switch off and unplug the iron when finished.
10. Allow the iron to cool completely before emptying the reservoir or storing it, as instructed.

⚠ Safety

- Never touch the hot soleplate or direct steam toward skin.
- Never leave a switched-on iron unattended, even briefly.
- Keep the cord away from the hot soleplate and edges of the ironing board.
- Do not use an iron with a damaged cord, plug, or loose electrical connection.
- Keep the iron away from water except for the intended reservoir.
- Keep children away from the iron and hot ironing board.

Care & storage

- Unplug the iron and allow it to cool before cleaning.
- Clean the soleplate using only the method recommended by the manufacturer.
- Empty the water reservoir after use if the instructions require it.
- Store the cooled iron securely with its cord loosely arranged.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using a high temperature on delicate or synthetic fabric.
- Leaving the hot soleplate resting on fabric or the ironing board cover.
- Filling the reservoir while the iron is hot or plugged in.
- Wrapping the power cord tightly around the iron while it is hot.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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